Binoculars



Category: **Audio-Visual, Camera & Media** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 3 labs

Covers these lab items: Binoculars, magnifying glasses, and field microscopes for plant and animal observation; Larger binoculars or spotting scopes for wildlife viewing; Professional binoculars

What it is used for

To observe distant objects, wildlife, or field details using binoculars. To obtain a clear image through correct focusing, stable handling, and suitable eye adjustment.

Main parts

- Objective lenses
- Eyepieces
- Focus wheel
- Diopter adjustment
- Hinged bridge
- Neck strap or protective case

Before you start

1. Inspect the lenses, body, focus wheel, and strap for damage.
2. Clean the lenses with a suitable lens cloth.
3. Adjust the binocular hinge to match the distance between the eyes.
4. Check the viewing area for safe footing and suitable visibility.
5. Use a tripod adapter if required for heavier binoculars or extended viewing.

How to use

1. Hold the binoculars securely using both hands or the neck strap.
2. Look through the eyepieces and adjust the hinge until both fields merge.
3. Close one eye and focus using the central focus wheel as instructed.
4. Adjust the diopter for the other eye if the model provides this feature.
5. Look through both eyepieces and fine-tune focus on the subject.
6. Keep the binoculars steady and avoid sudden movements.
7. Lower the binoculars when moving through uneven terrain.
8. Fit the lens caps and store the binoculars after use.

⚠ Safety

- Never look directly at the sun through binoculars.
- Avoid walking while looking through the eyepieces.
- Keep lenses away from excessive heat, moisture, and dust unless the model is rated for those conditions.
- Use a strap to reduce the risk of dropping the instrument.

Care & storage

- Clean lenses only with suitable optical cleaning materials.
- Keep lens caps fitted when not in use.
- Store dry in a protective case.
- Avoid touching lens surfaces with fingers.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Focusing without adjusting the hinge for eye spacing.
- Using excessive force on the focus wheel.
- Cleaning lenses with rough cloth or paper.
- Looking at the sun through the binoculars.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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